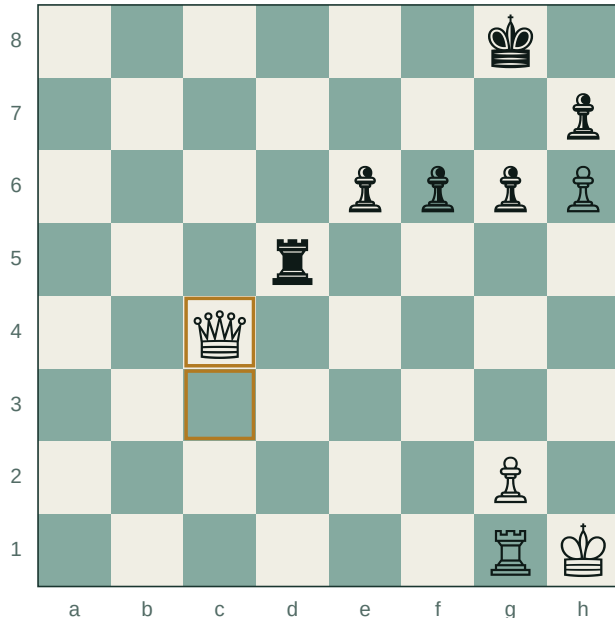


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 38

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Qxc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...Rh5+ 39. Qh4 Rxh4#

38...Rh5+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **39.Qh4**.

39...Rxh4# Mate: rook on h4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c4. Check for tactical protection.